

the eagle's eye



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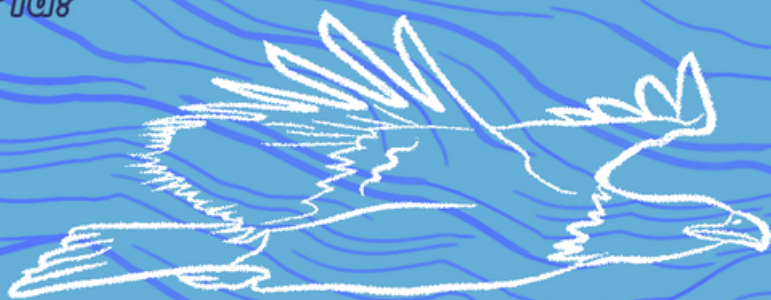
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UNITY SECONDARY SCHOOL



FOREWORD

Hey Unitians, it's Adhav, and although it's only been my second issue as Editor-in-Chief, it will also be the last time I lay my fingers on this newsletter. 😭 Over the past four years, I have been granted the opportunity to work on these issues, and I have held them close to my heart. Having joined this newsletter in my first year in Unity to working on six issues has been a blast and, for certain, one of the most convivial experiences of my life.

The Eagle's Eye is all about acting as a platform to provide a voice to our students and enlighten Unitians in any capacity. This issue, in particular, has been blessed with the insights of unprecedented student writers who have whole-heartedly written articles like the Impact of AI on the Future of Education, topics that may concern us.

We fervently hope that the ninth issue of The Eagle's Eye will be worthwhile, taking your mind off stress for a few minutes by having a fun time. With that, we hope you cultivate a passion for language arts and inspire you to enjoy writing!

Love,

Adhav 💖💖💖

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DELVING INTO ORGANIC FOOD'S

exorbitant
prices
^



By Yu Huan Chew (43) and Nadia Akbar (2B)

I'm sure many of us have made trips to the supermarket and seen a wide variety of organic foods. Many of us associate organic foods with being healthier and more expensive, but why is that so? This article will explore why organic foods are much more expensive than regular foods.

The definition of organic refers to the system of farming and food production; it is produced without the use of pesticides and other artificial chemicals that can be found in fertilizers. This means that in order to classify produce or farming methods as organic, we need to ensure that no artificial chemicals are used.

First and foremost, organic foods are chemical-free. Organic farms do not use chemicals, synthetic pesticides and GMOs (Genetically Modified Organisms) to help with farming, but why do non-organic farms use non-natural methods? This is because non-organic methods of farming reduce the amount of labour needed and are more cost-effective. Therefore sparing them the need to hire more workers to carry out manual labour such as hand-weeding, cleaning up polluted water and more. Resulting in organic farming spending more money, time and effort, which is reflected dearly in their hefty prices. People will have to pay more for all the hard work that goes into growing organic foods.

Secondly, high demand cannot match the low supply. It is no secret that organic foods are highly sought after. This is likely due to the widespread belief that organic foods are healthier than conventional food. Studies have shown that organic foods have a moderate increase in nutrients as well as a decrease in cadmium levels compared to non-organic foods.

What is Cadmium? Cadmium is a toxic metal found in soils which are absorbed by plants. While fewer dangerous bacteria are found in organic meat, non-organic foods are still within health guidelines and are equally edible. Despite proof that non-organic foods are safe, people still prefer organic foods. Due to these reasons, there is a high demand for organic foods. As a longer time is required for organic foods to grow and the high demand for them, the prices rose.

In addition, the process of growing organic food is tedious, and the cost of producing it is expensive. More labour is required as many procedures have to be followed. For example, because organic food has a higher class level, it needs to be both safe for consumption while being healthy at the same time. Organic foods are to be kept untouched to keep up to these standards, only allowing organic foods to be in contact with water. Due to all this tedious work that organic farmers have to deal with, they are often rewarded with more commission when they sell their organic foods.

In conclusion, despite organic food being way better than non-organic foods, people would still choose non-organic foods. The reason being it is cheaper and more affordable. We would all think that organic food is for high-class people whereas non-organic food is for low-class people. However, it doesn't matter what kind of food you buy, no matter whether one is more expensive and the other is cheaper as in the end, the ingredient would end up being the same dish.

ECHO CHAMBERS

ON SOCIAL MEDIA



By Diane Khoo (21)

Living in an age of technology, social media is a big part of many of our lives. Most social media platforms use algorithms to enhance the viewing experience. After a period of time, these algorithms will gather information on things you have viewed and enhance the viewing experience by repeatedly recommending them to you. The more you "like" these posts, the more likely they will show up on your feed; This creates an echo chamber.

An echo chamber is an environment where a person only encounters information or opinions that reflect and reinforce their own, and are repeated inside a closed system and isolated from counter-arguments. Echo chambers can create misinformation and twist a person's perspective, making them have difficulty considering other opposing viewpoints. By participating in an echo chamber, people are able to seek out information that reinforces their existing view without encountering opposing views, potentially resulting in confirmation bias which is the tendency to favour information that reinforces existing beliefs. Echo chambers may increase social and political polarisation (the divergence of attitudes from the centre towards ideological extremes), which causes separation within communities.

While echo chambers can be found anywhere information is exchanged, finding like-minded people and perspectives via social media is much easier. This has made echo chambers far more prominent and easy to fall into. On social media, echo chambers are thought to limit exposure to diverse perspectives, favouring and reinforcing ideologies. Social media sites also have a special kind of echo chamber called a filter bubble; it is a state of intellectual isolation that can result from personalised searches when a website algorithm selectively guesses what information a viewer would like to see based on information about the viewer, such as location, past click-behaviour, and search history.

Websites will then use those algorithms to primarily show you content similar to what you've already seen. If you receive all your information from algorithms being sent through your phone, it is likely just repeating whatever biases you have, forming a pattern that will lead to you living in your own bubble. Social networks are often accused of encouraging polarisation and widening ideological division. A study in Proceedings of the National Academy of Science (PNAS) shows how different platforms foster different levels of segregation in online communities, depending on their feed algorithms and social networking features. Some studies point out echo chambers as an emerging effect of human tendencies, such as selective exposure, contagion (a process which amplifies the spread of information in a social network), and group polarisation.

Recognising echo chambers can be tricky, especially if you're in one. If you ever wonder whether you are stuck in an echo chamber, here are some tips on how to recognise and avoid echo chambers. Firstly, to recognise an echo chamber, you can ask yourself whether multiple perspectives are being voiced, as they tend to only give one perspective on an issue or an opinion. Their viewpoint is also mainly supported by rumours or incomplete evidence and information. Lastly, when facts are presented against their viewpoint, they are disregarded. To avoid falling into echo chambers, you should make a habit of checking multiple sources to ensure that you're getting the complete picture. Try to interact with people who share different views from you, and take the time to discuss new ideas and facts with patience and respect. Most importantly, remember that just because you want something to be true, it doesn't automatically make it a fact.

AI'S IMPACT

Is It Changing Our World for the Better?

By Adhav Anbalagan (43)

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is revolutionising the world, from medicine and transportation to finance and entertainment. The potential of AI is vast, and the impact it will have on our society is immeasurable. The education sector is one area where AI is already making a significant impact. Let's explore AI's impact on the world and education in this exciting new era.

What is Artificial Intelligence, and why is it important?

AI is a branch of computer science that aims to create machines that can perform tasks that usually require human intelligence. These tasks include recognizing speech and images and making decisions based on data. AI uses a combination of algorithms and learning techniques to simulate human-like intelligence.

The enthralling aspect of AI lies in its ability to automate complex tasks, improve efficiency and accuracy, and create new opportunities for innovation. AI can help solve some of the world's most pressing problems, from climate change to healthcare, and improve our quality of life.

AI's Impact on the World

AI is already transforming various industries, including healthcare, finance, and transportation. AI can analyse patient data in healthcare to identify potential health issues and recommend treatment plans. In finance, AI can help detect fraudulent activity and make more accurate predictions about financial markets. In transportation, AI is leading the development of self-driving cars, which could reduce accidents and improve traffic flow.

AI also changes the way we interact with technology. Voice assistants like Siri and Alexa (found in Apple and Amazon products, respectively) use natural language processing to understand our requests and respond appropriately. Social media platforms use AI to personalise our feeds and recommend content that matches our interests. E-commerce sites use AI to suggest products based on our past purchases and browsing history.

While the benefits of AI are clear, there are also concerns about its impact on human employment. Some experts predict AI will replace human workers in specific industries, leading to job losses. While others argue that AI will create new jobs and opportunities, it requires workers to develop new skills and adapt to a changing economy.

AI's Impact on Education

AI has the potential to transform teaching and learning by providing personalised instruction, automating administrative tasks, and improving educational outcomes.

One of the most significant advantages of AI in education is its ability to provide personalised instruction. By analysing student data, AI can identify each student's strengths and weaknesses and tailor instruction to their individual needs. This personalised approach can improve student engagement and help students achieve their full potential.

AI can also automate administrative tasks, such as grading and lesson planning, freeing teachers' time to focus on instruction and student support.

This automation can also help reduce teachers' workload and increase efficiency, allowing schools to provide a higher quality of education.

Another benefit of AI in education is its ability to improve educational outcomes. By analysing student data and identifying patterns, AI can help identify areas where students may struggle and provide solutions. This data-driven approach can improve student achievement and ensure all students receive the support they need to succeed.

ChatGPT's Role in AI and Education

A large language model trained by OpenAI, Chat Generative Pre-trained Transformer (ChatGPT) is a prominent chatbot that plays an essential role in the development of AI and its impact on education. ChatGPT is designed to simulate human-like conversations and provide personalised responses to users' requests.

In the context of education, ChatGPT can be used to provide students with personalised feedback and support. For example, students could ask ChatGPT for help with a particular concept or receive feedback on their writing.

ChatGPT can also facilitate online learning and provide students with access to educational resources. Using natural language processing and machine learning, ChatGPT can help students navigate online content and provide personalised recommendations based on their interests and learning needs.

Another way that ChatGPT can impact education is by providing language translation services. ChatGPT can translate content in real-time, making it easier for students to access educational resources in their native language. This can help to reduce language barriers and improve access to education for students from diverse backgrounds.

However, there are also potential challenges associated with using ChatGPT in education.

► Sam Altman, co-founder of OpenAI and creator of ChatGPT



For example, there are concerns about the accuracy and reliability of ChatGPT's responses, particularly regarding more complex topics.

Additionally, it can also hinder the creativity of the literary world. ChatGPT can generate ideas and expand the writer's vocabulary. The model may also help to inspire new literary genres or styles. Although ChatGPT has the potential to revolutionise the literary world, it can also reduce originality as the writer may rely too heavily on the suggestions and prompts provided by the model. Furthermore, young writers may use this model to get assigned essays written on time. It is vital to consider its potential negative impacts and use it responsibly as a tool to supplement human creativity rather than as a replacement for it.

Recognizing that ChatGPT is not a substitute for human teachers and mentors is crucial. While AI can provide personalised instruction and support, there is no substitute for the guidance and mentorship provided by skilled teachers and mentors.

In conclusion, AI is transforming the world in many ways, including education. By leveraging AI's potential to provide personalised instruction, automate administrative tasks, and improve educational outcomes, we can create a more efficient and effective education system that supports the needs of all students. With tools such as ChatGPT, we can provide students with personalised feedback and support, helping them to achieve their full potential.

FREE TO PLAY!



But at What Co\$t?

By Emmanuel Lee (45)



With the rise in technological advancements, the video game industry has developed, changed and morphed drastically over the years. Contemporary gaming typically sports fancy high-speed 64-bit computer/ console processors, flamboyant red-blue-green (RGB) lighting and stylish see-through computers. In recent years, mobile gaming also sees a surge in popularity among youth, boasting a wide selection of captivating games that appeal to all. However, beneath the covers of these seemingly harmless games, unbeknownst to consumers, lies a manipulative and exploitative profit-driven industry; some games even solely exist to extract as much money as possible from players. In this article, I pull back the shades and expose the predatory monetisation tactics in the gaming industry, which is more of a blatant daylight robbery.

At a cursory glance, video game companies monetise their products to players through in-app purchases (IAPs'). They achieve this through one of the most commonly adopted frameworks found in all top-grossing video games, the 3 Golden Hs, HOOK, HABIT and HOBBY. This framework essentially manufactures desire in players and gains control over them in the game. Over their playtime in the game, their choices, and most importantly, their finances and spending on IAPs' within the game world. The industry often uses this model to extract the maximum amount of money a person is willing to part with. Even taking advantage of the few that don't know any better or can't help themselves (i.e. gullible children, chronic addicts or pathological gamblers). Therefore to maximise profits from IAPs, design choices are heavily based on the 3H model in conjunction with other dirty tactics to 'concoct' these 'cash-grabbing' video games. Well, what other dirty tactics are there, you might ask? One word: Gachas.

Gashapons are Japanese vending machines that disperse collectables randomly after inserting coins or tokens. Similarly, video games implement the 'gacha' or loot box mechanic where players use in-game currency, either bought from real money or 'grinded' from a player's blood, sweat, and tears, to purchase a 'roll' or 'pull' giving them a chance to randomly obtain a highly valued virtual item, cosmetic, weapon or character. Some games with this mechanic can include Overwatch 1, Team Fortress 2 and FIFA. The perfidious odds of receiving rare or valuable items are often ridiculously low, hence evoking players to make multiple pulls to get what they want. To illustrate this, the popular tactical first-person shooter game, Counter-Strike: Global Offensive (CS: GO) has this mechanic implemented in their loot crate system. If a player wanted to unbox just a regular knife or a glove skin, the odds would be 0.25575% per case. However, to unbox highly valued knives, that would be around 0.02558% chance per case. Similar to slot machines in casinos, this mechanic encourages gambling and rewards players with instant gratification every time money is spent. This, in turn, builds unhealthy spending habits as players become addicted and start to shell out obscene amounts of money before they even begin to notice they are in a 'skinner box'.

In addition, players who wish to obtain a specific item can not outright buy them! The huge pay wall, accompanied by a factor of 'luck' makes it close to impossible for players to obtain their desired item. That is if they can cough out huge sums of money or grind for days, months or years. Hence this randomised reward mechanic is malicious to players', and 'gachas' and loot boxes are a tactic of predatory monetisation.

Another common tactic of predatory monetisation in games is currency distortion, in which games disguise the true cost of virtual items.

When it comes to spending real-world money on games' IAPs, most games have a variety of thematically fitting currencies: crystals, coins, gems, points or credits et cetera. Currencies which are all designed intentionally to create a disconnect between the numbers on screen and a player's real-world wallet. As a result, the cost in real-world currency for any individual item is hidden, which once again distances players from the real cost of things. In addition, these currencies can only be purchased in pre-determined amounts. Hence players cannot simply buy the item and must always overpay. For instance, this tactic is present in the open-world action role-playing game Genshin Impact. If I wanted to get the trendy 'Red Dead of Night' Dilluc character skin worth 2480 crystals, I would be looking to spend my money on two options. The 3280 crystal bundle for \$69 or the 1980 crystal bundle for \$45 with a 980 crystal bundle for \$22 to get a total of 2960 crystals for \$67. Either way, no matter how you purchase the item, there will always be leftovers. Hence the psychology of the players would be to spend even more money in an attempt to use up the leftover currency from the previous purchase. But players do not realise that they will still have leftovers upon buying more currency and spending them. And so, the vicious cycle repeats as players sink more and more money into the game, not knowing that their 'leftovers' will never deplete to 'zero'.

Furthermore, the virtuality of the currency makes the player feel like they have not spent any physical cash at all. This makes it extremely easy for players to spend hundreds of thousands without the tangibility of lost money. The real-world equivalent of this is casino chips. Hypothetically, real notes or coins could be used to bet on a casino table, but casinos want patrons to forget that they are even spending money at all so they turn to poker chips instead. Therefore currency distortion is another tactic of predatory monetisation.

Lastly, and most notoriously, is the use of pay-to-win mechanics. One of the primary reasons why players spend money on IAPs is so that they can 'stomp' or bully weaker players. Pay-to-win games often offer massive advantages to players who spend money on IAPs or currency, giving them an unfair superiority over players who do not.

FREE TO PLAY!

But at What Co\$T?

In many games, this creates a situation where players who do not spend money (Free- to- Play players) are severely disadvantaged, making it exceedingly troublesome for them to compete or progress in a specific game. In stark contrast, the players who spend money on the game (Pay-to-Win players) become gods among men, giving players a power trip as they rampage through other weaker players. Exempli gratia, the multiplayer online action role-playing video game Diablo Immortal. When a player hits higher levels, the difficulty for progression for free-to-play players increases exponentially as a result of massive experience point reductions coupled with terrible drop rates. The only thing free-to-play players can turn to for further progression is to convert to a pay-to-win player and use in-game currency to buy loot boxes coined 'legendary crests' in Diablo Immortal for a slim chance of obtaining something good. More often than not, players will be throwing their money away. Therefore, the use of pay-to-win mechanics is another tactic of predatory monetisation.

So what can we do? I would say to be aware of these tactics, keeping in mind that there could be even more tactics we do not know of, exercising self-control on one spending. As well as to spread awareness to your friends and family. Ultimately, I suggest you support genuinely good games that are not toxic, ergo games developed to create enjoyable and memorable experiences, not games that are just hungry for your wallet.

To sum up, while in-game purchases can be a legitimate way for game developers to make money, there is a growing concern about the detrimental impacts of predatory monetisation practices and tactics on vulnerable players. Those are children who may not fully understand the consequences of spending money, those with internet gaming disorders or addictions and those who gamble compulsively. I think that the gaming industry needs to have the moral ethics and responsibility to ensure that their games are not exploiting players for profits or exacerbating destructive spending habits. One should also be smart and keep a lookout for these common pitfalls.

The Hypocrisy in Our Society

By Cherise Cheong (44)

The fabrication of a false persona of virtue or righteousness that conceals genuine character, including, among other things, concealment, dishonesty, or fraud, or the practice of engaging in the same actions or behaviours that one criticises another person for.

Everybody knows nobody can stand a hypocrite. Lie to yourself or others all you want, but deep down, it's impossible not to get annoyed at one, especially when they're against you. But truth be told, every single one of us has been prone to hypocrisy against one another at some point. We're no saints.

You may believe in morality and the 'right thing to do'. However, think about all the excuses when it comes to your own shortcomings. Is hypocrisy a defence mechanism? A way to project and or avoid responsibility against accusations from others?

Many of us accuse the other party of doing the same thing, whether to impress someone else or bring somebody down. Ironically, when it comes to us, it's 'different'. In my opinion, this stems from the inability to be deferential (also known as being aka humble) along with our pride and ego. The reality of how things work makes living by our principles or upholding high moral standards difficult. We benefit greatly from people's positive opinions of us being kind and polite individuals, remaining entirely ignorant of any constrictions. The fear of accountability paired with the feeling of being morally superior to one is the driving force in most situations.

For instance, you are gossiping about somebody's work performance, although secretly, you're guilty of the same thing. It's a deflection to avoid dealing with your own issues and the fear of judgement. Everybody wants to be accepted, and nobody wants to be 'in the wrong'.

That said, to address the elephant in the room, how do we stop it?

Well, to avoid being one or to reduce the number of times we are a hypocrite, we must first see if there are any contradictions in our own jurisdiction and judgement. Being objective means there is no space for interpretations or exceptional cases and that facts remain facts regardless of who, where, what, why etc. Just like how regardless of the situation, abuse is still abuse, and murder is still murder. We should also accept that, in the end, that imperfection is of human characteristic. Maturity is to admit and recognise our mistakes and then correct them. It can also be beneficial to picture ourselves in other people's situations. Acknowledge other people. Learn about your enemies. Take into account where they are coming from, and do not jump to conclusions.

To end it off, remember that, once again, nobody wants to deal with hypocrites. People are more likely to forgive you for admitting mistakes than refusing or dragging others down (nobody likes snitches). Don't be afraid of being human; authenticity is refreshing.

TEENAGERS BEING TEENAGERS

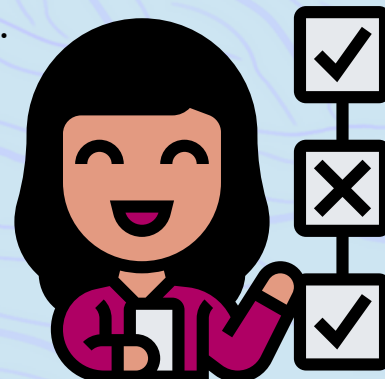
□ Breaking □ School □ Rules

By Kate Yee (31)

Ironically, breaking certain rules in school is not even considered "breaking school rules" anymore, as it has become ubiquitous in school. Hence, most people find them socially acceptable. What is the cause of this bizarre phenomenon? Is it social media? Is it the desire to want to be "cool"? Is it the cliché "monkey see, monkey do?" It is not a secret that many students have been at fault for not complying with school rules in some instances. Wearing excessive jewellery and making Instagram "confessions" pages to effectively 'cyberbullying' others are some of the many rules students do not comply with. "Students like to wear friendship bands. Lately we saw more girls wearing necklaces too. Wearing necklaces can be dangerous when one falls, especially during PE lessons or in crowded places, such as canteen queues, assembly in the hall, or the parade square." Mr Chew, our very own Discipline Master, added. Undoubtedly, wearing jewellery is a confidence booster, and it could have been a friendship bracelet that your friend specially made for you and is of sentimental value to you. Despite that, it still deters from the school rules! The school handbook clearly states in the code of conduct that "All students are not allowed to wear jewellery or accessories when in any school uniform".

Furthermore, confession pages punctuate the growth of our schools with Unitians who lead themselves and serve others. It goes against Unity's aim for respect, tainting the school image. Seeing your name in a post with "XXXX looks so good!" may feel good. However, imagine if you were in the shoes of someone who saw their name on a post saying something along the lines of "XXXX has a very bad personality". Such posts develop a toxic environment. By proven results, it has been concluded that cyberbullying can affect someone emotionally, with anxiety, depression, and stress, sometimes for an extended period of time. Many students may share a desire to break the rules sometimes, with the influence of others, but let's not make it a bad habit.

From afar, these might seem like rudimentary and unnecessary rules, but even the smallest of things also contribute a factor in how good a school's discipline is. From a positive perspective, these rules were established for everyone's good, to build a good school reputation with future-ready Unitians. Keeping this in mind, let's do our best to follow school rules. Zig Ziglar, an American author who encouraged others to look at the bright side of life, said, "When you do the right things in the right way you have nothing to lose because you have nothing to fear". Following the rules can start with one person and continue with everyone.



Is HBL the New Normal?



By Azrhiel Gucon (31)



What is the new normal? When the pandemic first started, some might say it was the mandatory wearing of masks everywhere. However, this fundamental rule has been lifted since 13 February 2023, as mask-wearing is optional even on public transportation. So, what could be considered the new normal now? For school staff, and especially students, it would likely be Home-Based Learning (HBL). During the pandemic, schools implemented HBL for learning to take place efficiently at home in hopes of reducing the students' exposure to the virus. Now, after two years, having it fortnightly is normalized, as though it is part of the school curriculum.

Though it may seem like an unconscious habit, it was exhausting when it first came about. Teachers had to plan their online lessons, be it on Zoom or Student Learning Space (SLS), beforehand. They also had to ensure everyone was on task from their homes. For students like us, it had its pros and cons.

Firstly, we could save a lot of time and money. As it is now once every two weeks, we would not need to wake up extra early to prepare and get ready for school, as we can do our school work on our bed, in our home clothes. Furthermore, we are not limited to food within the canteen and would not need to spend any money on food, so we would not have to worry about that. Therefore, it is very convenient to do schoolwork at home.

Additionally, we can complete our homework at our own time and own pace. This helped me understand my concepts better. I could slowly learn without the pressure of finishing the work in the given period of the lessons.

We learnt to be more self-directed and responsible for our learning as the work would usually be due by the end of the day, so we could manage our time properly to get everything done. Therefore, studying at home is very beneficial for students.

However, there are also many disadvantages. Most students only recently learnt how to be independent in their learning. Many students get easily distracted as they are in the comfort of their own homes, with no teachers and classmates to monitor their progress. For example, parents would tell their children to do chores during "school" time. This harms their studies as when they return to school, they would be lost and have immense stress catching up with the rest of the class. This harms their mental health and could make them less motivated to study, especially since receiving help from peers and teachers from home is more arduous. Therefore, doing school work at home is ineffective due to many distractions.

Moreover, as homes are usually shared spaces between family members, having personal space with all their needs is challenging, from good wifi connections to a well-lit study area for the whole day. In particular, those who share a room with a family member are most affected as they would need to share everything and may also unknowingly bother each other. Some may feel uncomfortable when their family members are there when studying. This affects their studies as they do not feel comfortable enough to do their work at home without their family members disturbing them. Therefore, students may study poorly at home because of the lack of personal space.

All in all, getting used to working and studying at home was a new and complicated experience, with all the ups and downs, and one we can all learn from. Adapting quickly to get back on track was quite tricky. The pandemic has made us realize how much we take things for granted, so we should all persevere and look at the positive side of things, looking forward to the near future when the new standard can be called normal.

Is My Friend Too Concerned ABOUT THE ENVIRONMENT?

By Ling En Chen (44)

We all have worries, don't we? Whether it's about our studies, our futures, or more, they tend to trap us in a loop of apprehension every time we think about it. This feeling is no different from the concerns your friends may be facing around today's environmental issues. Statistics and social media posts often paint a grim picture of the climate situation we live in. "The Climate Disaster Is Here", "Code Red For Humanity", and "Warning On Escalating Climate Crisis", just to name a few. When these terrifying headlines are paired with pictures of flaming forest fires or people struggling to escape a heavy flood, wouldn't you be concerned too?

From social media hashtags to songs written about caring for our planet, the issue of climate change is a complex topic to escape from nowadays. Just by stepping out of the house today, we inevitably get hit by sweltering gusts of wind. That, unfortunately, is not just the nature of Singapore's climate but also a direct attack from global warming. According to The Centre for Climate Research Singapore, our Little Red Dot's daily mean temperature is projected to increase by 1.4°C to 4.6°C towards the end of this century. This also means that as early as the year 2045, we could be experiencing days with peak temperatures of 40°C! Each and every day that we choose to ignore this information, Singapore is only getting warmer and warmer!

Temperatures around the world are also escalating, enabling the atmosphere to hold and release enormous amounts of water, which will eventually affect millions of people around the globe with extreme storms, floods and droughts.

Even in the coldest regions of our planet, global warming overpowers them all. A study by the journal, Science, has found that nearly half of the world's glaciers outside of the Greenland and Antarctic ice sheets will melt by the end of the century, even if the world's ambitious global warming goal is met. As a result, we will be suffering the consequences of the Earth's rising sea levels much earlier than we may have realised. The mean sea level around Singapore is projected to rise by up to 1 metre by 2100. With one-third of our country being less than five metres above sea level, we are especially vulnerable to large-scale flooding and erosion of our garden city.

Sadly, that isn't the end. Loss of biodiversity, deforestation, food waste and plastic pollution are just a few other environmental catastrophes we are currently facing. The worries for the future and health of our planet are still very prominent in our lives and terrifying to think about. Some people stay oblivious to it, while others stay wary of every move they make to maintain an eco-friendly lifestyle. The friends in our lives who choose to worry about every eco-unfriendly action may not be making the healthiest lifestyle choice. However, they undoubtedly have an excellent reason to be concerned. As a matter of fact, the survival of planet Earth determines not only the future of mother nature but also the future of every single one of our lives. The careers we dream of having, and the families we intend to build, depend not only on whether the Earth can survive till then but also on whether we allow it to. If the Scientists are right, we only have around ten years before we fall into a climate catastrophe, so what will you do about it?